

Technology for learning

Technology has a powerful role to play in supporting the learning and social needs of people with a range of physical, sensory, communication, or cognitive disabilities. Some features are specially designed for people with disabilities, but many, such as spell-checkers used by people with dyslexia, are used by almost all computer users.



Dictation



Switch control



Descriptions



Audio



Zoom



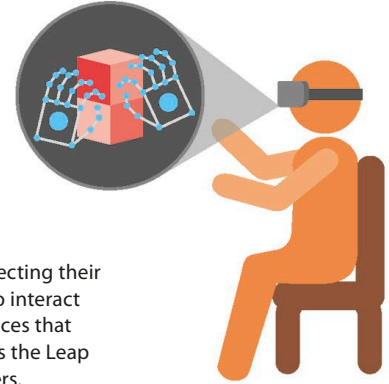
Speech

△ Accessibility options

Mobile and desktop devices have built-in accessibility options such as magnification, colour and contrast choices, page de-cluttering, and text-to-speech.

New technologies

New devices are emerging based on virtual reality that can help people who are newly disabled to adjust to navigating the world using, for example, a motorized wheelchair. Disabled people can also meet up and interact with others in “virtual world” applications.



▷ Gesture control

People with disabilities affecting their fine-motor control can also interact with computers using devices that recognize gestures, such as the Leap Motion, or Kinect controllers.

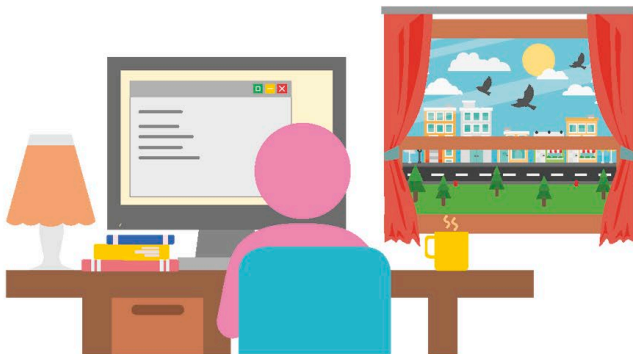
REAL WORLD

Charity-made apps

Several disability charities have created apps addressing the needs of the people they work with. These apps range from fundraising to helping people with disabilities in extreme situations, such as accessing life-saving relief in the aftermath of a natural disaster.

Computing and disabilities

Having a disability isn't a barrier to learning to code. Thanks to assistive technologies people with a variety of abilities are able to learn coding skills and get jobs in the computer science industry. Many companies are happy for their programmers to work from home, which can be a helpful option for disabled coders.



BIOGRAPHY

Farida Bedwei

Born in 1979 in Nigeria, Bedwei was diagnosed with cerebral palsy at the age of one. Despite her mobility and muscle co-ordination being affected, she has become an extremely successful software engineer and businesswoman.



◁ Autistic spectrum disorders

Many people with autistic spectrum disorders (ASD) have a natural attention to detail, which is extremely useful for coding.